USER INTERFACE AND DESIGN
EXPERIMENT – 8

Aim:

The aim is to create storyboards representing the user flow for a mobile **E-commerce application**, including categorized browsing, using **Balsamiq**.

Procedure

1. **Tool Used:** Balsamiq Wireframes (https://balsamiq.com)
2. **Project Creation:** I started a new mobile project and utilized the "Hand-drawn" skin to focus on the structural layout and user logic.
3. **Component Selection:** I used the UI library to select standard mobile components like Search Bars, Grids, List Items, and Navigation Bars.
4. **Flow Integration:** I added a specific "Categories" layer to simulate how a user transitions from broad browsing to specific product groups.
5. **Design Focus:** The wireframes were kept clean and simple, ensuring that the navigation buttons and "Add to Cart" actions are prominently placed for easy interaction.

User Flow

1. **Home Screen** – Starting point for exploring featured items and current offers. 2. **Product Categories** – A dedicated screen to help users filter products by type (e.g., Electronics, Fashion, Home).
3. **Product List** – Shows items filtered by the selected category with essential details like price and ratings.
4. **Product Details** – A full breakdown of a single item's specifications and images. 5. **Checkout** – Review of selected items and entry of shipping details.
6. **Order Confirmation** – Final confirmation of payment and order placement.

Detailed Screen Analysis

1. Home Screen

- **Components:** Search Bar, Promotional Banner, "Shop by Category" shortcut, and Featured Products.
- **Purpose:** To engage the user and provide multiple entry points into the store's inventory.

2. Product Categories Screen

- **Components:** * Grid view of category cards (e.g., Electronics, Men's Wear, Furniture).

    - Icons or thumbnail images representing each category.
    - Search filter to find categories quickly.
- **Purpose:** To prevent "information overload" by allowing users to narrow down the catalog based on their specific needs.

3. Product List Screen

- **Components:** Product thumbnails, Titles, Price labels, and a quick "Add to Cart" button for each item.
- **Purpose:** To allow users to browse and compare several products within a specific category at once.

4. Product Details Screen

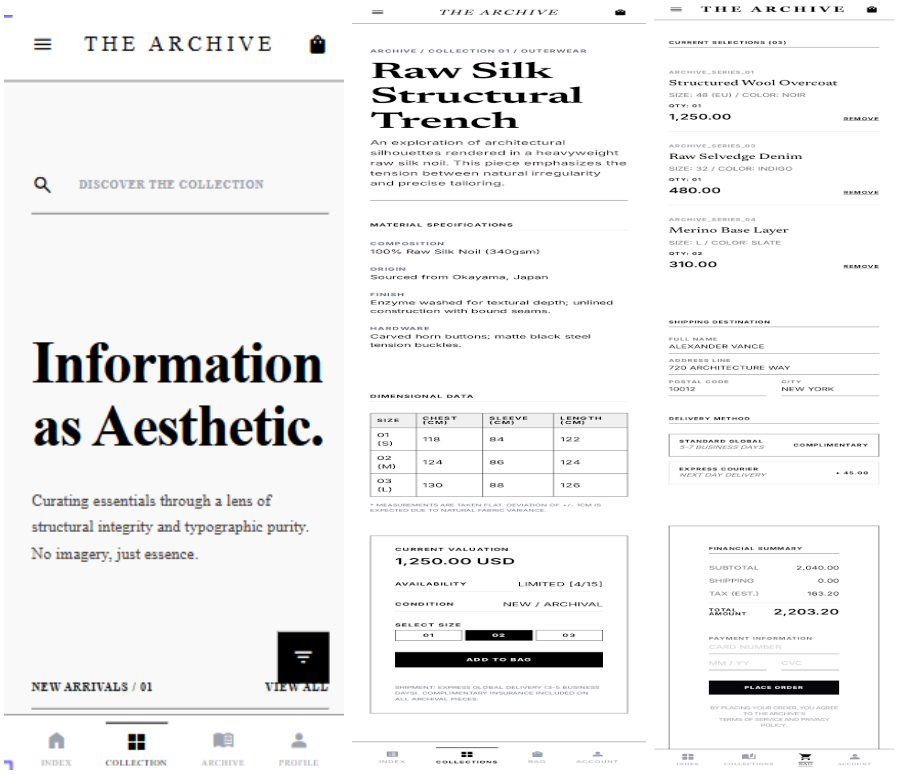
- **Components:** Large Product Image, Detailed Description, Customer Reviews, and a prominent "Buy Now" button.
- **Purpose:** To provide deep context and build trust so the user feels confident in making a purchase.

5. Checkout Screen

- **Components:** Summary of Cart Items, Shipping Address fields, and a "Proceed to Payment" button.
- **Purpose:** To collect necessary shipping information and show the final price before the transaction.

6. Order Confirmation Screen

- **Components:** "Thank You" message, Order Reference Number, and an Estimated Delivery timeline.
- **Purpose:** To confirm the transaction success and provide the user with follow-up information regarding their delivery.



Conclusion

By including a dedicated **Product Categories** screen, the user flow becomes significantly more organized. This experiment demonstrates how a structured navigation system in Balsamiq helps reduce user friction, making it easier for customers to find specific products and proceed to a successful order confirmation.